



January 12, 2021

Grangereau Pascal,
Director, Agence Française de Développement (AFD),
Relais International Business Center Building,
12 Charles de Gaulle Street,
Area 11, Asokoro,
FCT Abuja.

Dear Sir,

PARTNERSHIP ON INNOVATION & ICT SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

Firstly, I want to wish you and the rest of the AFD delegation in Nigeria a Happy New Year and a prosperous 2021 ahead.

The Ilorin Innovation Hub is a new initiative of the Kwara State Government aimed to boost the adoption of technology within the state by skills and learning programs in order to transform the state into a self-sustainable and modern haven for digital entrepreneurs. One of the programs the state has conducted, Digital Kwara, has trained 13,000 youth in digital marketing with many other learning programs starting this year. We are also launching a hybrid startup incubator and accelerator program in Ilorin to train and mentor entrepreneurs. One other initiative of the state geared towards driving technology is the reducing the of right-of-way charges for laying of telecommunication fiber cables to almost zero.

Given our plans for the year and programs, we would like to partner with AFD in the following areas:

1. **Educational Technology** – We are prioritizing Edutech solutions for learning across various levels of education (primary, secondary and tertiary) and pushing to include STEM and ICT into the curriculum of state schools. We need assistance with:
 - a. Equipping of Training Centers across the state
 - b. Online ICT Training Content
2. **Renewable Energy Innovation** – We are also looking at ways to disrupt urban electrification and spread rural electrification within the state using modern solar technology.
3. **Tech Startup Grants** – We will be giving grants to tech companies in our Ilorin Startup Growth Program and Coding Hackathons. We also need assistance in this regard.

We are looking forward to a partnership with AFD to speed up the impact of our Innovation Hub in Kwara State.

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